

## Average first-innings total in IPL



dismissing Kings XI Punjab for 119 after setting a modest target of 132. Between 2015 and 2022, SRH failed to reach the playoffs just twice, making two finals and lifting its maiden title in 2016.

### The shift: From defence to aggression

SRH's bowling-centric strategy began to unravel as Warner's form dipped and Rashid Khan departed for Gujarat Titans in 2022. Without their bowling linchpins, the team struggled, finishing near the bottom in the 2022 and 2023 seasons.

A transformation was inevitable, and with the arrival of Cummins as captain in 2024, SRH underwent a radical shift. The team adopted an ultra-aggressive batting philosophy, discarding its past conservatism. The results were immediate – in IPL 2024,

SRH scored at a blistering run rate of 10.04, breaking the record for the highest IPL total twice in the season.

Gone was the steady accumulation followed by a death-over assault. Instead, SRH hit top gear from the outset. Travis Head's inclusion alongside Abhishek Sharma made for a devastating opening pair, smashing PowerPlay runs at 10.52 per over – an all-time IPL record – with the lowest dot-ball percentage (38.4%). The emergence of all-rounder Nitish Kumar Reddy alongside Heinrich Klaasen further strengthened the middle order, while the Impact Player rule allowed for sustained aggression. By the end of the season, SRH had racked up six 200-plus totals.

### Challenge of sustainability

The high-risk, high-reward

strategy proved highly effective throughout IPL 2024 – until the final, where SRH suffered a dramatic collapse against Kolkata Knight Riders, falling short in its quest for the title.

The start of IPL 2025 has raised fresh concerns. After a spectacular 286-run opening salvo against Rajasthan Royals, SRH has lost four consecutive matches, with its batting faltering on each occasion. However, Cummins remains steadfast in his commitment to an all-out attacking approach.

"A few teams, when they go to a new venue, they think, 'let's play it safe and get 160-170.' That's not our team. We got 280 vs RR; that's the kind of team we want to be," Cummins told his players after a defeat to Delhi Capitals.

Whether the numbers will eventually balance in SRH's favour or their approach proves unsustainable remains to be seen. What is certain is that Sunrisers Hyderabad continues to push the boundaries of T20 batting, embracing a fearless ideology that could redefine their legacy – for better or worse.

*(All stats up to date as of April 8)*

### SRH's top five wicket-takers during the 2015-2021 phase

| Player            | Matches | Economy Rate | Wickets |
|-------------------|---------|--------------|---------|
| Bhuvneshwar Kumar | 87      | 7.59         | 98      |
| Rashid Khan       | 76      | 6.33         | 93      |
| Siddarth Kaul     | 43      | 8.6          | 52      |
| Sandeep Sharma    | 43      | 7.78         | 41      |
| Khaleel Ahmed     | 24      | 8.68         | 32      |